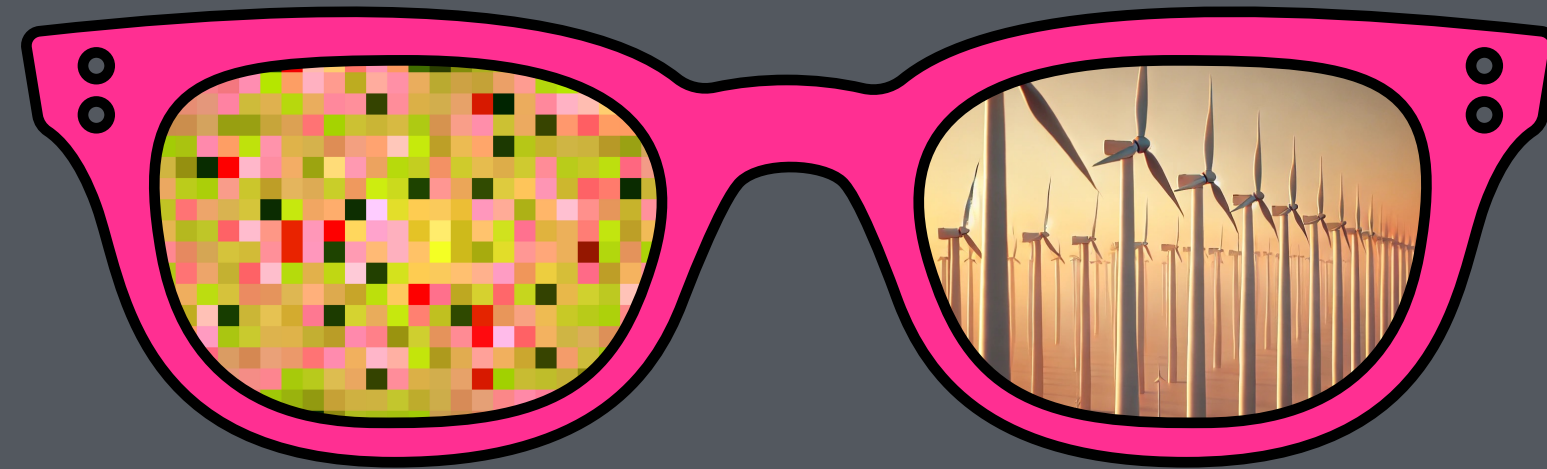


# Data and the State

DATA 20195 / 30195



## Housing and segregation

Lecture 15, Monday May 11

recall the statistical boom in  
incarceration in 1990s.  
what's going on?

# Policing is tied to incarceration

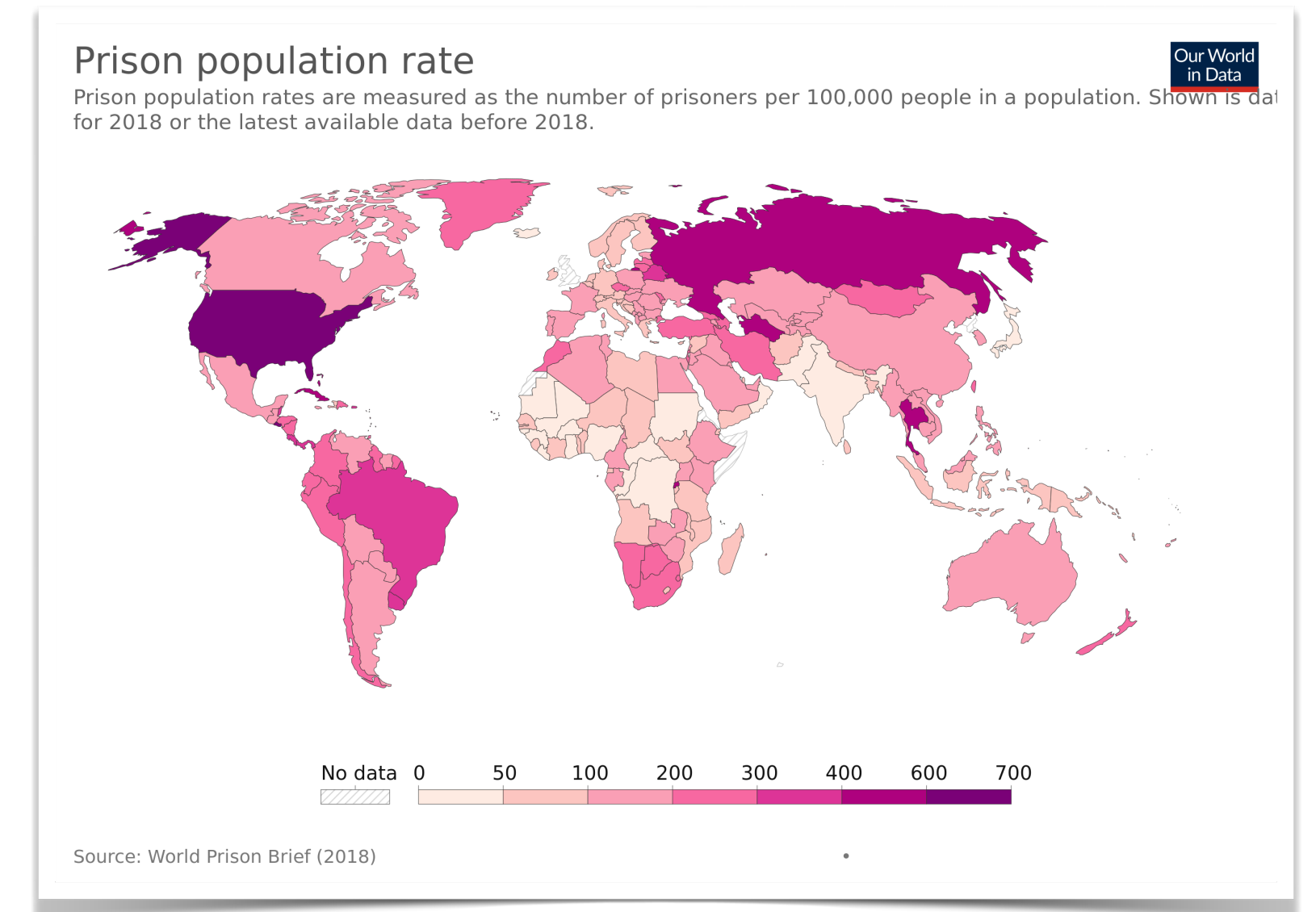
2018 map

- I combined a bunch of stats from different (reasonable) sources to get the following summary of how many people are incarcerated, per 100,000 adults.

- 1940- **201**, 1950- **176**, 1960 - **193**, 1970 - **161**, 1980 - **220**, 1990 - **457**
- 2000 - **683**, 2010 - **731**, 2020 - **505**, 2022 - **541**

(NB. be slightly careful with these numbers due to different data sourcing)

- This is massively more than (most of) the rest of the world. According to [World Prison Brief](#) from 2024, Russia/Brazil in **300-400** range, UK **140**, Croatia **115**, South Africa **249**, Turkey **424**, Sweden **96**, Japan **33**
- (China's official estimate is **120-130**, but this clearly excludes many classes of detainees.)
- El Salvador's Nayib Bukele is making a major authoritarian play to lead the world in incarceration — declared a state of emergency in 2022 and now estimates put the incarceration rate at a whopping **1659**



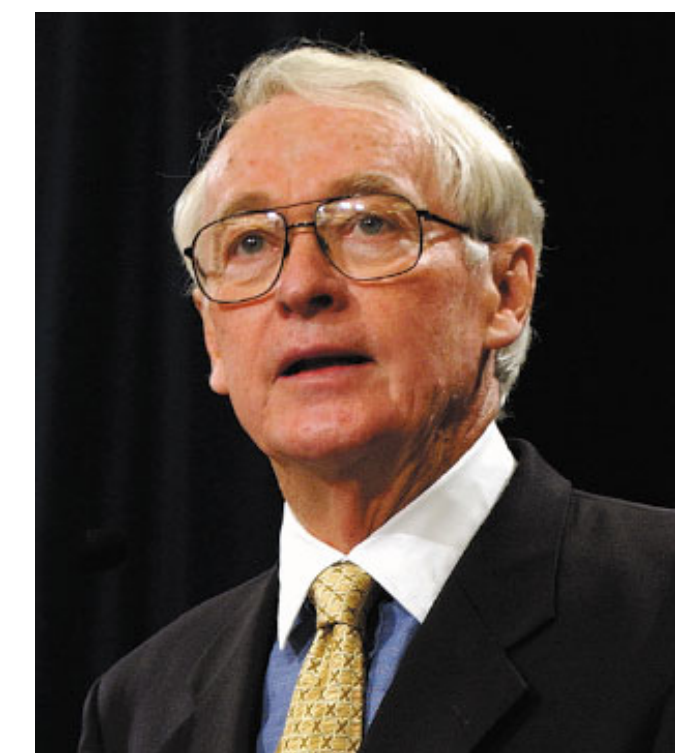


# Academics shape (but rarely initiate) the discourse

- John Dilulio Jr (Princeton/Penn political science), coined “superpredators” in 1995 magazine piece, doubled down in 1996 book *Body Count*
- Warned of coming wave of remorseless, hyper-violent young offenders; demographic trends would unleash hundreds of thousands of these youths on American cities by the early 2000s
- Building on work by his advisor James Q Wilson, who wrote on a huge array of topics: bureaucracy, police tactics, drugs, punishment, nature vs nurture
- Wilson: “drug use is wrong because it's **immoral** and it is immoral because it enslaves the mind and destroys the soul”

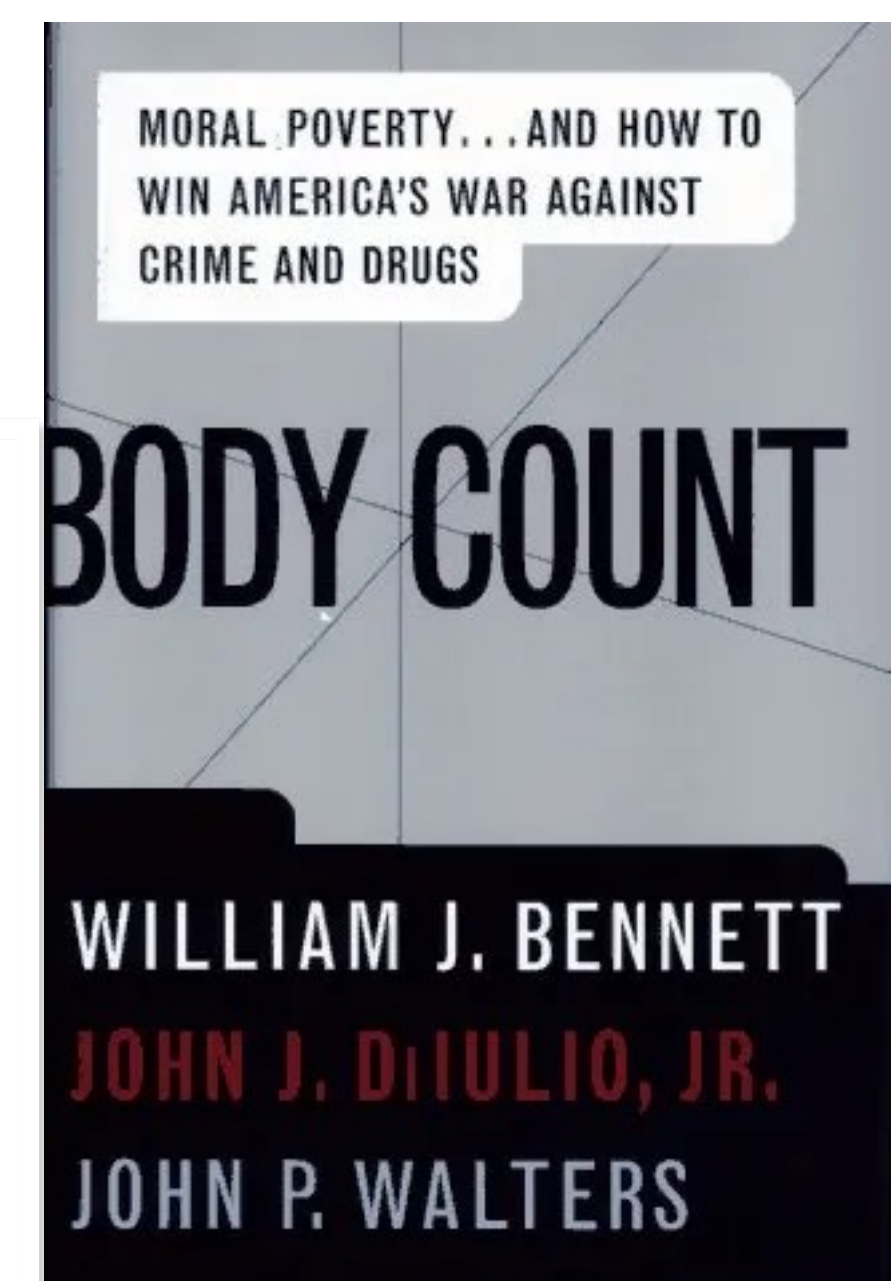


1995



Wilson

Ronald Reagan Professor of Public Policy at Pepperdine



1996



Dilulio



the discourse has a  
pre-history

# Willie Horton attack ad

1988 presidential campaign

- 3rd party PAC ran “Weekend Passes” ads attacking Michael Dukakis, running against George HW Bush in 1998
- (though the line of attack had been debuted by Al Gore in the primary)
- Successfully painted Dukakis as “weak on crime”





# Central Park Five

- 1989 - jogger brutally attacked in Central Park, NYC
- dozens of teenagers had been in the park and were targeted as a “wilding” gang
- a certain real estate developer takes out a full-page ad calling to string them up
- police coerced confessions, ignored evidence — eventually all five exonerated



Yusef Salaam,  
now a NYC city councillor

ADVERTISEMENT

## **BRING BACK THE DEATH PENALTY.**

## **BRING BACK OUR POLICE!**

What has happened to our City over the past six years? What has happened to law and order, to the neighborhood cop we all trusted to safeguard our homes and families, the cop who had the power under the law to help us in times of danger, keep us safe from those who would prey on innocent lives to fulfill some distorted inner need. What has happened to the respect for authority, the fear of rebellion by the courts, society and the police for those who break the law, who wantonly trespass on the rights of others? What has happened to the complete breakdown of life as we know it.

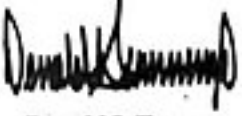
Many New York families — White, Black, Hispanic and Asian — have had to give up the pleasure of a leisurely stroll in the Park at dusk, the Sunday visit to the playground with their families, the bike ride at dawn, or just sitting on their

they should be executed for their crimes. They must serve as examples so that others will think long and hard before committing a crime or an act of violence. Yes, Mayor Koch, I want to have these murderers and I always will. I am not looking to psychoanalyze or understand them, I am looking to punish them. If the punishment is wrong, the blame on innocent people will stop. I recently watched a newsman trying to explain the "langer" in these young men. I no longer want to understand their anger. I want them to understand our anger. I want them to be afraid.

How can our great society address the continued brutalization of its citizens by crazed mindless Criminals? Must we wait until their CIVIL LIBERTIES END WHEN AN ATTACK ON OUR SAFETY BEGINS?

When I was young, I sat in a diner with my father and witnessed two young bullies cursing and threatening a very frightened woman. Two cops rushed in, lifted up the thugs and threw them out the door, warning them never to come trouble again. I miss the feeling of security New York's finest once gave to the citizens of this City.

Let our politicians give back our police department's power to keep us safe. Unhackle them from the constant chain of "police brutality" which every petty criminal hurls immediately at an officer who has just risked his or her life to save another's. We must cease our continuous pandering to the criminal population of this City. Give New York back to the citizens who have earned the right to be New Yorkers. Send a message loud and clear to those who would murder our citizens and reverse New York — BRING BACK THE DEATH PENALTY AND BRING BACK OUR POLICE!

  
Donald J. Trump

DAILY NEWS, Monday, May 1, 1990



# Policy framing, legislative correlates

- Joe Biden was lead author or co-author of string of punitive legislation
- Comprehensive Crime Control Act (1984)
- Anti-Drug Abuse Acts (1986, 1988) — created notorious 100-to-1 crack/powder cocaine sentencing disparity
- Crime Bill (1994) — funded 100,000 new police officers, authorized roughly \$9 billion for prison construction (with incentives for states to adopt truth-in-sentencing laws), expanded the federal death penalty to dozens of new offenses, created the federal three-strikes provision, and eliminated Pell Grants for incarcerated people.



“predators on our streets”  
floor speech from 1993



# Policy framing, legislative correlates

- “Take back our streets from crime gangs and drugs”
- “...We have finally gotten more police officers on the street—that was one of the goals that the president had when he pushed the crime bill that was passed in 1994. He promised 100,000 police; we're moving in that direction, but we can see it already makes a difference, because if we have more police interacting with people having them on the streets we can prevent crimes, we can prevent petty crimes from turning into something worse. But we also have to have an organized effort against gangs, just as in a previous generation we had an organized effort against the mob. We need to take these people on. They are often connected to big drug cartels. They are not just gangs of kids anymore—they are often the kinds of kids that are called **superpredators**: no conscience, no empathy. We can talk about why they ended up that way but first we have to bring them to heel.”

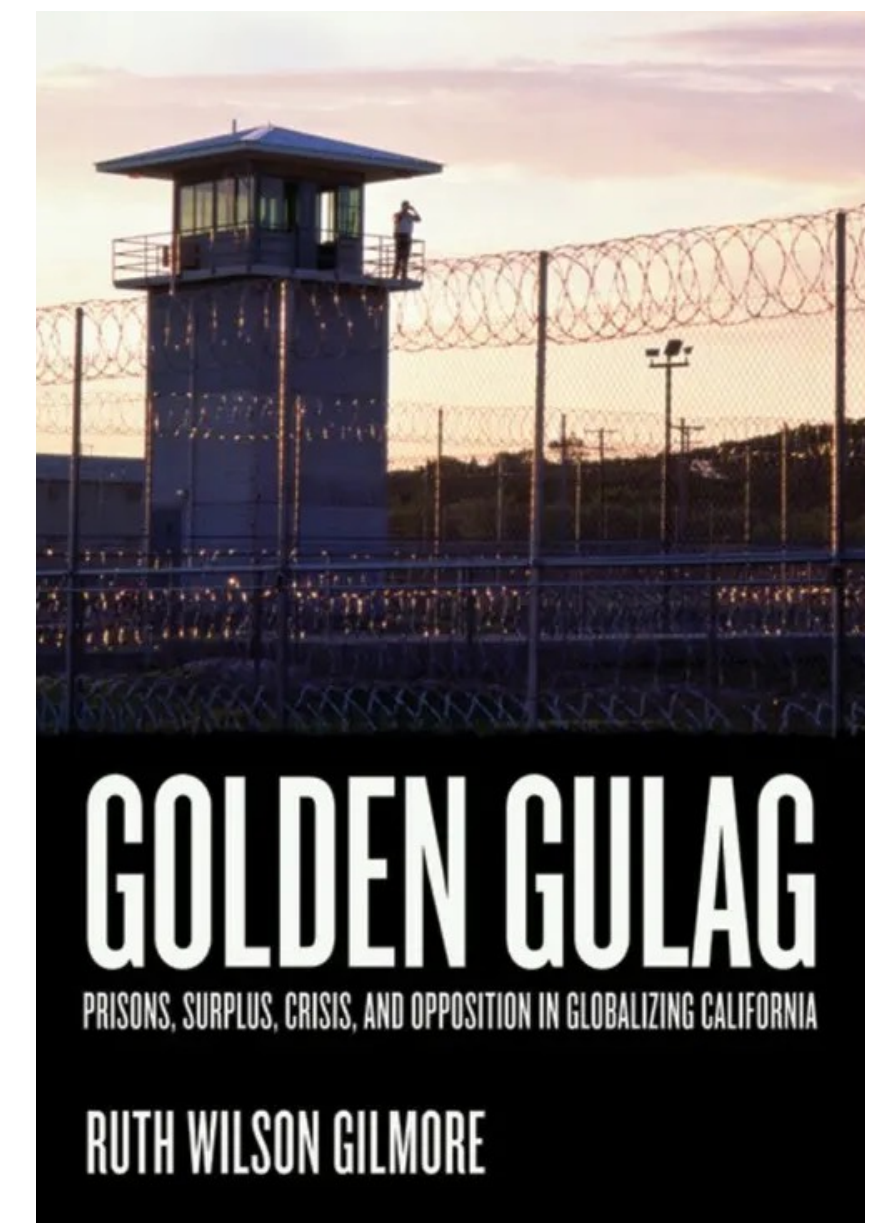


what does **critical** academic  
engagement look like?



# Ruth Wilson Gilmore

- Professor of Earth and Environmental Sciences, Africana Studies at CUNY. Directs Center for Place, Culture and Politics.
- Prisons as "partial geographical solutions to political economic crises"
- Teaches how to read causal claims about crime data with structured walk-through of standard explanations for prison growth
  - crime and crackdown, drug epidemic — doesn't track timeline
  - structural unemployment leads to crime — mixed story
  - mandatory sentencing — definitely exacerbates explosion of carceral state, doesn't bring down crime
  - prison labor, private-prison lobbying, rural jobs — not explanatory
- "Why now" frame — follow the surplus (land, labor, capital, state capacity)
- "Tipping point" finding: removing two or three people from a block destabilizes the rest. This flips the causal arrow: incarceration **produces** the conditions we associate with crime.



2007



# Lum and Isaac

- Data scientist Kristian Lum, political scientist William Isaac
- “[I]t is clear that police records do not measure crime. They measure some complex interaction between criminality, policing strategy, and community–police relations.”
- Predictive policing “is aptly named: it is predicting future policing, not future crime.”
- Method: create a “demographically representative synthetic population of Oakland, California” combining census demographics with survey data from 2011 National Survey on Drug Use and Health
- West Oakland, International Blvd 200x overrepresented in arrest data

## To predict and serve?

Predictive policing systems are used increasingly by law enforcement to try to prevent crime before it occurs. But what happens when these systems are trained using biased data? **Kristian Lum** and **William Isaac** consider the evidence – and the social consequences



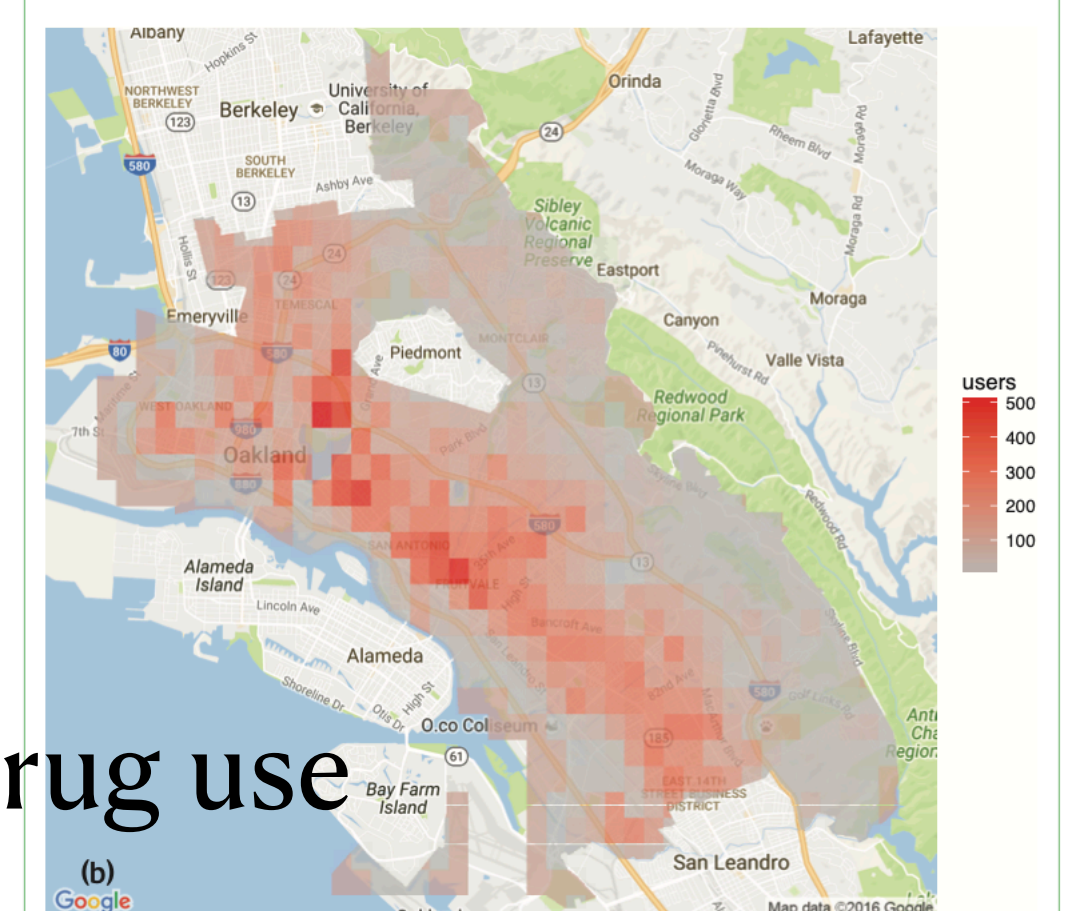
**Kristian Lum, PhD** is the lead statistician at the Human Rights Data Analysis Group



**William Isaac, MPP** is a doctoral candidate in the Department of Political Science at Michigan State University



drug arrests



drug use

**FIGURE 1** (a) Number of drug arrests made by Oakland police department, 2010. (1) West Oakland, (2) International Boulevard. (b) Estimated number of drug users, based on 2011 National Survey on Drug Use and Health



drug arrests



drug use

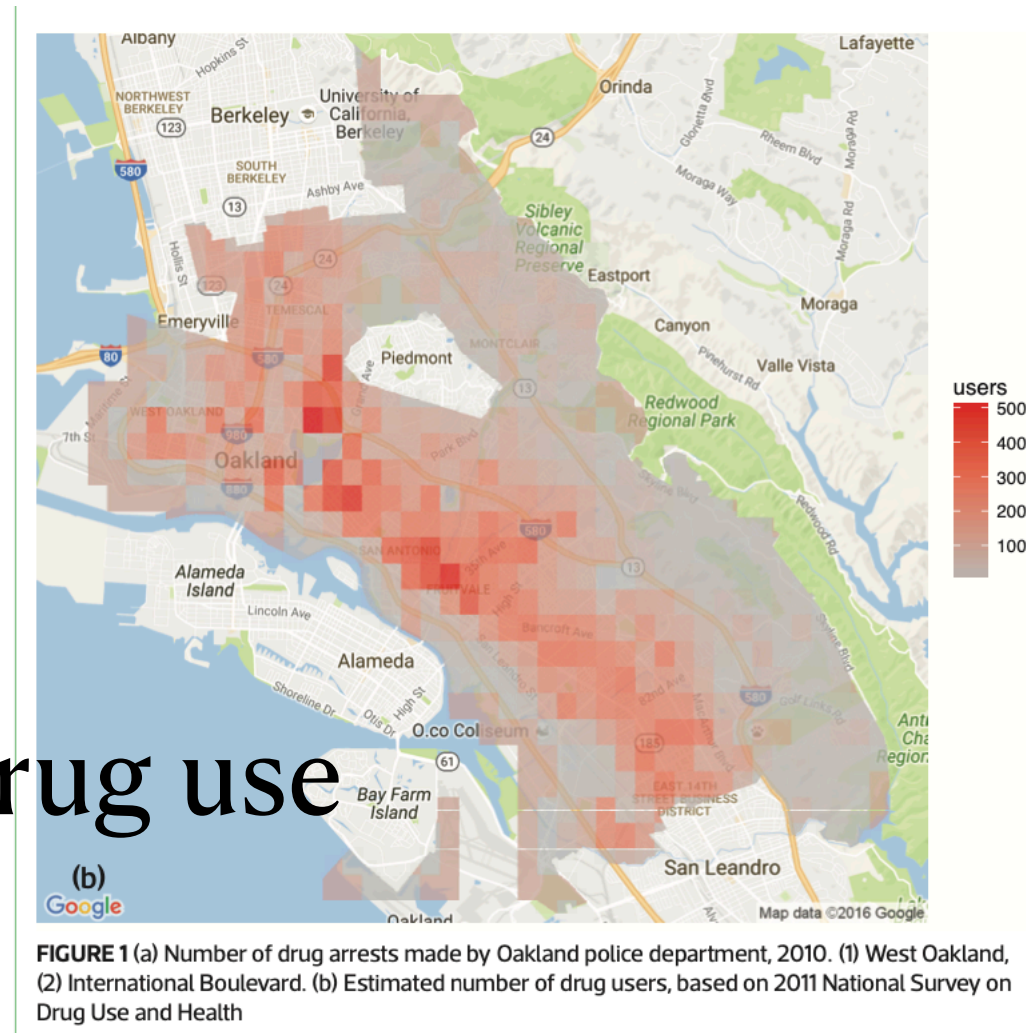
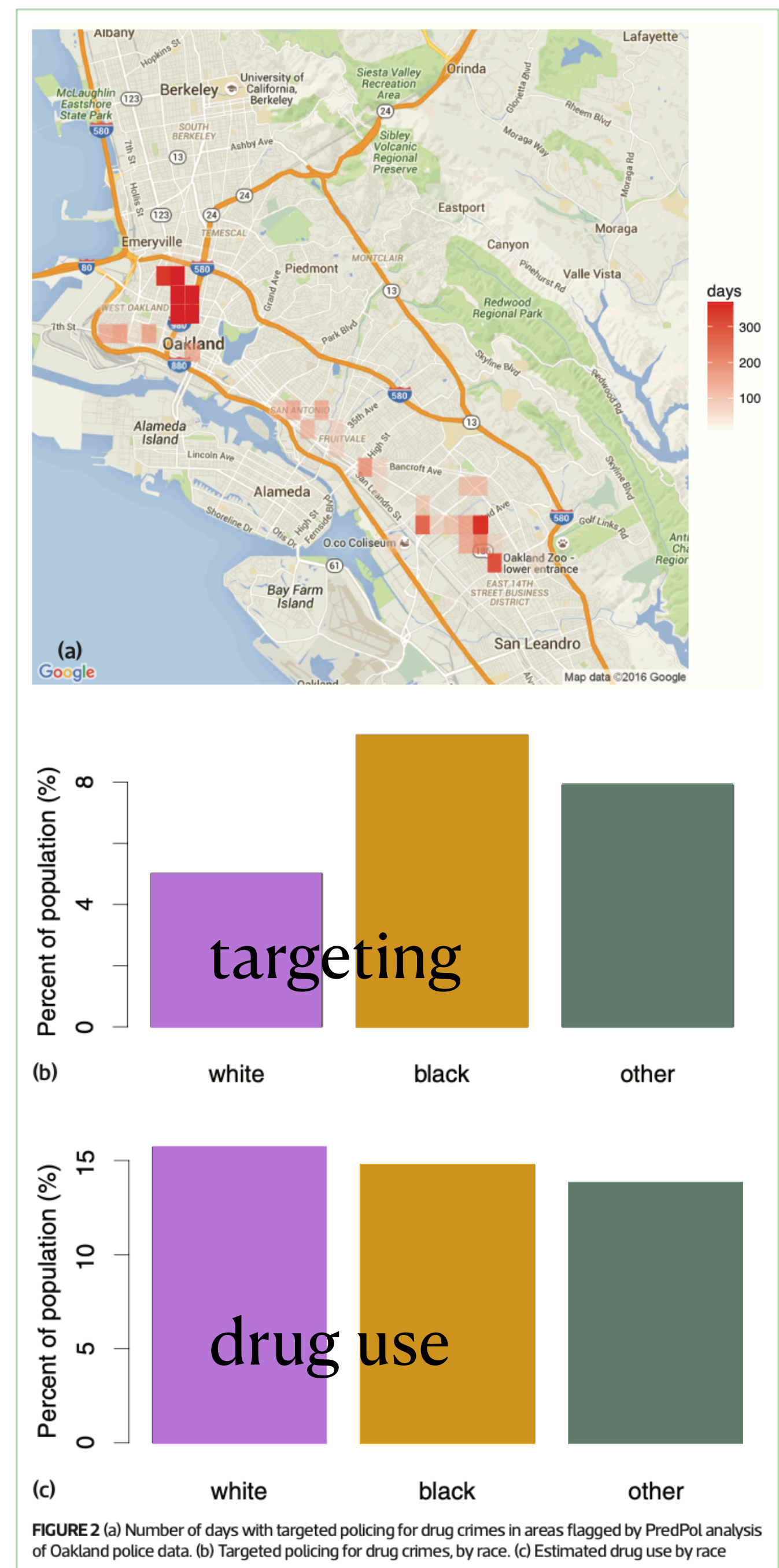


FIGURE 1 (a) Number of drug arrests made by Oakland police department, 2010. (1) West Oakland, (2) International Boulevard. (b) Estimated number of drug users, based on 2011 National Survey on Drug Use and Health

Then they apply **PredPol** — Bertozzi’s commercial software! earthquake-based model for “one-day-ahead prediction of the crime rate”

PredPol billed as a “parsimonious race-neutral system” that uses “only three data points in making predictions: past type of crime, place of crime and time of crime. It uses no personal information about individuals or groups of individuals, eliminating any personal liberties and profiling concerns.”







# Housing and the state, 1776-1940

- 1917 U.S. government builds temporary housing for war workers — first federal involvement
- 1929 Great Depression, 1930 Franklin Delano Roosevelt elected, 1930s **New Deal** transforms government engagement in **infrastructure** (basic durable built environment — structures and facilities)

- **Public Works Administration** (PWA, 1933-1944) — dams, bridges, hospitals, schools, airports, ...
- **U.S. Housing Authority** (1937) — creates funding for construction of public housing
- **Home Owners' Loan Corporation** (HOLC) offers refinancing support for mortgages to prevent foreclosures
- **Federal Housing Administration** (FHA) offers mortgage insurance, promoting homeownership for middle-class families



“relief, recovery, reforms”





# Housing and the state, 1940-1970

- G.I. Bill (1944) — gives (White) veterans access to affordable home loans, fueling suburban growth
- Suburbanization — FHA (Federal Housing Administration), VA (**Veterans Administration**) support (White) suburban developments like Levittown
- “Urban Renewal” policies of 1950s-60s — tear down “blighted” projects
- Civil Rights Era — recognizing legacy of redlining, restrictive covenants
  - 1968 **Fair Housing Act**
  - 1974 introduction of **Section 8** housing vouchers to subsidize private rentals for low-income households
  - **HUD** — department of Housing and Urban Development, enters cabinet 1965 as part of LBJ’s “Great Society”





# Housing and the state, 1970–now

- 1980s neoliberal turn — Reagan cuts HUD, increased emphasis on vouchers and markets, Bush I **HOPE** programs (Homeownership and Opportunity for People Everywhere)
- 1990s — Clinton-era **HOPE VI** “New Urbanist” program de-emphasizes public housing, favors mixed-income development (dense, walkable, with public transit), triggers/accelerates gentrification
- 2008 housing crisis — “subprime” mortgages have become exotic/risky financial products; market collapses and leads to mass foreclosures
- Response: massive bank bailouts (TARP), some homeowner aid (HAMP/HARP), nearly nothing for renters
- Today: serious, systematic shortage of housing stock





# Renting a home

- Progressive Era (turn of 20th c) housing reform — **Tenement** laws and housing codes to address crowding, poor construction and sanitation
- Tenement districts include NYC (lower East Side), Boston (North End, South End), Chicago (South Side, Back of the Yards), ....
- New Deal created local housing authorities with subsidized housing for low-income tenants
- Goals: avoid slum conditions, create housing tied to employment opportunity





# Depression, post-war, and beyond

- Public housing projects — built with great optimism! but many fell to disinvestment, disrepair, stigma

|                     |              |           |
|---------------------|--------------|-----------|
| Pruitt-Igoe         | St Louis     | 1954-1972 |
| Cabrini Green       | Chicago      | 1942-2011 |
| Robert Taylor Homes | Chicago      | 1962-2007 |
| Marcy Houses        | Brooklyn     | 1949–     |
| Nickerson Gardens   | L.A.         | 1954–     |
| Jordan Downs        | L.A. / Watts | 1944–     |

|                  |                     |              |
|------------------|---------------------|--------------|
| Brewster-Douglas | Detroit             | 1935-2014    |
| Techwood         | Atlanta             | 1936-1990s   |
| Queensbridge     | Queens              | 1939–        |
| First Houses     | NYC Lower East Side | 1935–        |
| Lafitte          | New Orleans         | 1940-Katrina |
| Magnolia         | New Orleans         | 1941-Katrina |

- Recall the afterlife of this period from last week's classes: HUD (1965), Fair Housing Act (1968), Section 8 (1974)
- **Tenant rights** movement: security deposit limits, habitability standards, rent control, eviction procedures, right to counsel







# Peter Hepburn

- Sociology professor at Rutgers-Newark, affiliated with Princeton's **Eviction Lab**
- Research into **inequality** includes
  - work and precarity
  - childcare and family structure
  - criminal justice
  - gentrification and neighborhood change



Pl: Matt Desmond



# Eviction in America

## Understanding and Addressing the Eviction Crisis

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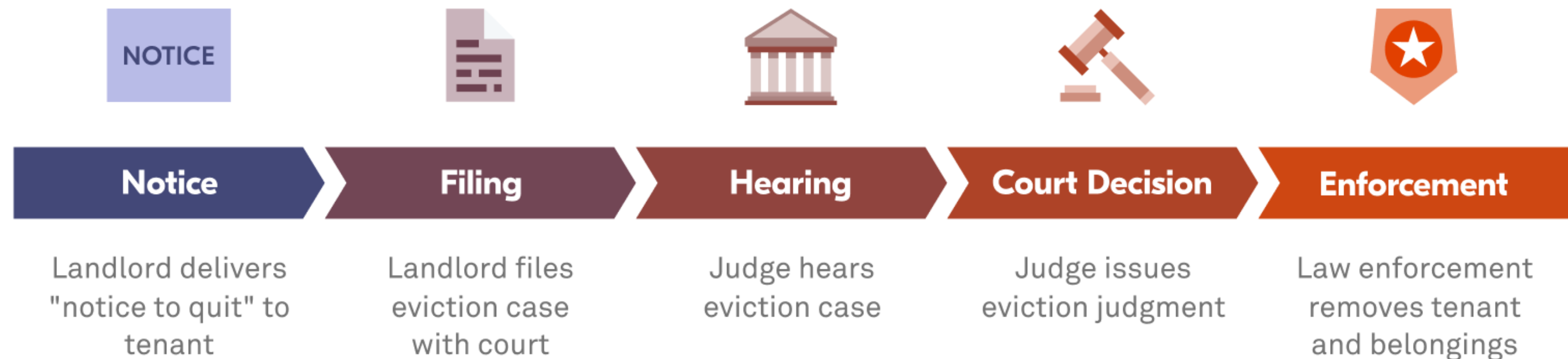
Peter Hepburn  
Rutgers University-Newark  
Eviction Lab, Princeton University



# Eviction in America

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- Defining eviction
  - Forced removal from rental housing
  - Formal and informal eviction
- The formal eviction process





# Negative repercussions of eviction

| Physical Health                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Mental Health                                                                                                                                                                  | Associated Conditions Among Women                                                                                                                                                                          | Associated Conditions Among Children                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Exposure to Sub-Standard Living Conditions                                                                                                            | Barriers to Livelihood                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Higher Mortality</li> <li>• Respiratory Conditions</li> <li>• High Blood Pressure</li> <li>• Poor Self-Rated General Health</li> <li>• Coronary Heart Disease</li> <li>• Sexually Transmitted Infections</li> <li>• Drug Use</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ Depression</li> <li>▪ Anxiety</li> <li>▪ Mental Health Hospital-ization</li> <li>▪ Exposure to Violence</li> <li>▪ Suicide</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ Physical Assault</li> <li>▪ Sexual Assault</li> <li>▪ Drug Use and Related Harms</li> <li>▪ Pre-term Pregnancies</li> <li>▪ Future Housing Instability</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ Lead Poisoning</li> <li>▪ Academic Decline</li> <li>▪ Food Insecurity</li> <li>▪ Emotional Trauma</li> <li>▪ Risk of Chronic Disease in Adulthood</li> <li>▪ Low Birthweight</li> <li>▪ Decreased Life Expectancy</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ Lead</li> <li>▪ Mold</li> <li>▪ Poor Ventilation</li> <li>▪ Pest Infestations</li> <li>▪ Crowding</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Failing credit scores</li> <li>• Downward move</li> <li>• Unemployment</li> <li>• Residential instability</li> <li>• Homeless-ness</li> <li>• Inability to access social services</li> </ul> |

# The hidden housing problem

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“Each year, an untold number of Americans are evicted or otherwise forced to leave their homes involuntarily. The number is likely in the many millions, but we have no way of gauging even a modestly precise figure for renters, because such data are simply not collected on a national basis or in any systematic way in most localities where evictions take place.”

-Hartman and Robinson 2003



# What is the Eviction Lab?

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- Research group based at Princeton University
- Central questions
  - How common is eviction?
  - What are the causes and consequences of eviction?
  - What can we do to lower eviction rates?
- Lots of publicly-available data!
  - [www.evictionlab.org](http://www.evictionlab.org)

# Data collection

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1. National eviction database, 2000-2018
    - Purchased data from LexisNexis
    - Validated against court-reported aggregates
  2. Eviction Tracking System, 2020-present
    - Scraping public-facing court dockets
    - Requesting data from the courts
    - Granted access to court systems
- Lots of cleaning, geocoding, linkage work!